



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Francis Classical Catholic Academy

School Website: <https://saintfrancisclassical.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Saint Francis Classical Catholic Academy (SFCCA) demonstrates strong alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements. The school presents a robust religious and metaphysical foundation (Catholic identity at the center of learning, liturgical life, catechesis), a clearly formed purpose (formation through virtue, wisdom, and the true good and beautiful), a curriculum built around the liberal arts, a pedagogy that blends contemplative and Socratic methods, a faculty model oriented toward virtue and mentorship, and a parents-and-community partnership that actively involves families in faith-informed, classical formation. Evidence across SFCCA materials highlights explicit Great Books, a Four-School Within the Academy (Pre-Grammar to Rhetoric), integration of liturgy and sacred practice, and a pedagogy that includes memorization, chant, and memory-driven recitation alongside Socratic discussion in upper grades. Collectively, these signals place SFCCA in the CLASSICAL category across all six categories of assessment.

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school emphasizes Christ-centered education, liturgical life, theology, and sacred practices (e.g., liturgical calendar, Rosary, catechesis). Positive keyword analysis: Terms such as truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; catechesis; Catholic; Christ; liturgical calendar appear in public materials. Approximately 9–12 positive indicators identified; negative indicators (secular relativism, value-neutral ethics) are not evident. Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The materials foreground transcendental realism and sacred practice, consistent with the Positive Keyword Indicators for Element 1.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission statements tie education to truth, goodness, beauty; formation over mere information; Great Books and Western civilizational formation are threaded through the day; reference to contemplation and “from wonder to wisdom.” Positive keyword analysis: Phrases and concepts like formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, great conversation, telos, and contemplation appear across SFCCA materials. Estimated positive keyword hits exceed negatives (which are not evident in public materials). Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The school consistently aligns with the classical aim of forming character and intellect toward universal truths, not merely job-readiness.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Public materials describe the seven liberal arts framework via the Pre-Grammar, Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric schools; explicit attention to Great Books and Western Civilization; integration of history, literature, philosophy, and sciences; emphasis on wonder. Positive keyword analysis: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium concepts; Great Books; history/western civilization; Latin; integration/wonder; and primary-source engagement are all present. Estimated positive keyword hits clearly outnumber any negatives. Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The curriculum is structured around the liberal arts and classic texts, with explicit Great Books and integrated study.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence:** A mix of contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé), memorization/recitation (chanting, memory work), and upper-school Socratic/seminar-like discourse; lower-school singing/chanting; rhetoric development in the upper grades. Positive keyword analysis: Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, chanting, memory work, imitation, master-teacher models, and rhetoric training appear in the public materials. No compelling negative pedagogy signals in these materials. Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The pedagogy aligns with traditional classical methods at multiple levels of schooling, with explicit memory work, recitation, and Socratic/seminar elements.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty pages highlight teachers with strong training in classical education (Latin, theology, humanities); there is emphasis on the teachers as mentors and exemplars; “faculty and staff” pages and the presence of a teacher-driven, literature-rich humanities program. Positive keyword analysis: Language such as model teachers/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; master-teacher models appear in knowledge resources and are echoed in SFCCA public materials (faculty sophistication, humanities emphasis). Estimated positive keyword hits exceed negatives. Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The public materials portray teachers as exemplars and core to the curriculum, consistent with classical faculty expectations.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: SFCCA materials emphasize parental partnership, open visits, family formation opportunities (book studies, lectures, catechesis), and community engagement; admissions/family involvement and financial-aid processes reinforce family engagement. Positive keyword analysis: Terms like partnership with families; parental engagement; home-school collaboration; family catechesis; open campus; parent formation are present. No negative signals observed in public materials. Result: CLASSICAL. Why: The school foregrounds parent partnership and family formation as essential to classical education.

Aggregate assessment: The school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories, based on strong textual signals in public materials and a curriculum/values framework consistent with the classical rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: Catholic-centered, liturgical practices, theology integration; Christ-centered education; liturgical calendar. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; catechesis; Catholic identity. No significant negative signals observed. Rating rationale: Strong transcendental/moral realism and liturgical practice align with classical foundations (Positive keywords abundant).
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: Formation-centered aims; formation over information; Great Books/Great Conversation approach implied; contemplation/rest in learning. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, teleology, contemplation, great conversation; No clear negative signals. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books and Western Civilization; integration across disciplines; emphasis on wonder. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, classical canon, interdisciplinary unity, wonder, etc. No negative signals evident. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Combination of Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, chanting, history through imitation; Socratic/seminar elements in upper grades; rhetoric training in the Rhetoric School. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include scholé, memorization/recitation, Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, memory work; Minimal negative signals observed. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Staff with classical education credentials; faculty as mentors; living curriculum evidenced by humanities emphasis. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher; Minimal negative signals. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Partnership with families, parent formation, open campus; families integrated through book studies, lectures, and catechesis; admissions process invites parental involvement. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, family formation; negative signals minimal. Rating: CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (as the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL across all six categories). No major needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully classical standing. If desired, the school could consider documenting explicit statements of each category's key classical indicators (e.g., explicit Great Conversation transcripts, formalized "living curriculum" language, and publicly visible teacher-mentorship profiles) to further strengthen public communication of classical alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.